

Figure 11: T.S. Subramania Pillai or Vakil Pandaram

Vakil Pandaram Pillai aka T.S. Subramania Pillai (Figure 11), a pleader himself, also managed the affairs of Singampatti Zamin, an affluent estate in the Tirunelveli district. Even before his involvement in SSNCo he had displayed considerable enterprise in establishing formal banking firms. A native of Tirunelveli town, he had founded, in the 1890s—in collaboration with B.K. Ramaier (an honorary auditor of SSNCo) and one Sadagopa Pillai—The Tinnevelly Bank Ltd, a firm that folded up soon due to the chicanery of a co-promoter. In 1902, he founded the South India Bank Ltd (later the Bank of Tamilnadu, amalgamated with the Indian Overseas Bank). He also owned the Sivaprakasam Press in Tuticorin and acted as the secretary of the Saiva Siddhanta Sabhai, a religious association through which VOC first entered public life.[18]